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G.U.R.U.

GUIDED UNIVERSITY RESEARCH UTILITY

User Guide

A complete guide to using G.U.R.U. as your AI doctoral research intelligence — from first setup to advanced vault and reference management.

CONFIDENTIAL · FOR LICENSED USERS ONLY

Getting Started with

G.U.R.U.

G.U.R.U. (Guided University Research Utility) is an AI-powered doctoral research engine built for PhD students in law and related disciplines. It acts as a permanent, always-available supervisor — challenging arguments, formatting citations, managing references, and preparing you for your viva.

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// 1. WHAT YOU NEED TO START

G.U.R.U. uses Google's Gemini AI and requires a free API key. You do not need to pay Google — the free tier is sufficient for regular doctoral use.

- 1 Go to aistudio.google.com/apikey in your browser

2 Sign in with your Google account

3 Click **Create API key** — no payment required

4 Copy the key (starts with `AIza`)

5 Open G.U.R.U. → click **CONFIG** → paste your key → click **Save & Calibrate G.U.R.U.**

6 Set your **PhD Research Focus** — describe your thesis area, university, and supervisor style

Research Focus example: "PhD in Law at University of Brighton. Thesis: Genomic Negligence — duty of care, causation, and liability for AI-assisted diagnosis under UK tort law. OSCOLA citations required. Supervisor is Professor [Name]."

// 2. THE INTERFACE AT A GLANCE

G.U.R.U. is organised into seven tabs across the top navigation bar:

TAB	WHAT IT DOES
Dialectic	Your main research conversation with G.U.R.U. — submit questions, arguments, drafts
Vault	Your research memory — upload notes, PDFs, session logs, articles
Refs	Built-in reference manager — OSCOLA citations, bibliography, Table of Cases
Viva	Live viva voce simulator with two AI examiners
Present	PDF presentation viewer with AI slide discussion
Archive	Full history of every conversation with export options
Tools	Document Bridge, OSCOLA formatter, Diff tool, Argument Map, Question Bank
Config	API key, voice, model, sync passphrase, and Pro licence

The **bibliography sidebar** (left panel on desktop) tracks every source G.U.R.U. mentions in conversation in real time.

// 3. DIALECTIC – YOUR AI SUPERVISOR

The Dialectic tab is where you conduct your research conversations. Type any question, paste a paragraph from your thesis, or ask G.U.R.U. to critique your argument.

How each response is structured

- **Reasoning** — a collapsible grey block showing G.U.R.U.'s private thought process before answering. Click to expand. Useful for understanding how the analysis was formed.
- **Response** — the main doctoral supervision reply, formatted in markdown (headers, bold, lists, OSCOLA citations)
- **Socratic Probe** — a purple italicised challenge at the bottom, only when your argument has a gap, unsupported claim, or unexamined premise. Not every message gets one.

Voice Input ()

Click the microphone button beside the input box to dictate your question. G.U.R.U. uses Gemini to transcribe your speech, then submits automatically. Useful during note-taking or when your hands are occupied.

Tip: Paste a paragraph from your thesis draft and ask G.U.R.U. to "critique this argument for doctoral rigour." The response will identify weak claims, missing citations, and logical gaps — exactly what your supervisor and examiners will look for.

// 4. SUPERVISION MODES

Six mode pills sit below the input box. Each changes G.U.R.U.'s analytical focus for the next message:

MODE	BEST USED FOR
 Supervise	General doctoral supervision — balanced guidance and development
 Critique	Rigorous argument critique — maximum pressure, identifies every weakness
 Sources	Finding and validating cases, articles, and legislation
 Consistency	Checking your argument for internal contradictions and logical gaps

**Expand**

Strengthening and extending a weak or underdeveloped argument

**Examiner**

External examiner perspective — hard scrutiny, viva-style challenge

Workflow tip: Draft an argument in Supervise mode, then switch to Critique to pressure-test it, then Consistency to check for contradictions. This mirrors the actual doctoral review cycle.

// 5. THE VAULT — RESEARCH MEMORY

The Vault is G.U.R.U.'s long-term research memory. Everything you load here becomes context that G.U.R.U. draws on when answering questions in the Dialectic tab — the more relevant content you add, the more grounded and specific its responses become.

Loading content

- **Drag and drop** files onto the vault drop zone
- Click **+ Load Files** to browse
- Supported formats: `.txt` `.md` `.json` `.pdf` (PDF requires Pro)

What to put in the Vault

- Your thesis chapters and drafts
- Key cases and judgments (paste from BAILII)
- Journal articles and book excerpts
- Supervisor feedback notes
- Research session notes and reading summaries
- Legislation text

Asking G.U.R.U. about a vault entry

Each vault entry has an **Ask G.U.R.U. →** button. Clicking it pre-loads the entry as context and opens the Dialectic tab, ready for your question about that specific document.

Search and delete

Use the search bar to filter entries by keyword. Click **x** on any entry to delete it (requires confirmation). Vault statistics — entries, sessions, and total words indexed — are shown at the top.

Important: The Vault is stored in your browser's local storage. Use Cloud Sync (Pro) to back it up across devices and protect against data loss.

The Refs tab is a built-in OSCOLA-first reference manager. Every reference you save is automatically formatted in both footnote and bibliography format, injected into G.U.R.U.'s memory, and available for one-click insertion.

Adding references – three methods

Paste Text

Paste any raw citation, paragraph, URL, or bibliography entry. G.U.R.U. extracts the metadata and generates the OSCOLA footnote and bibliography entry automatically. Works for cases, articles, books, legislation, and websites.

DOI Lookup

Enter a DOI (e.g. `10.1093/ojls/ggad012`). G.U.R.U. fetches author, journal, year, and volume from CrossRef (free, no API key needed) and formats it as OSCOLA.

Manual Entry

Select a reference type from the dropdown. Form fields adapt to the type — case parties and law report for cases, authors and journal for articles, publisher and edition for books. G.U.R.U. generates OSCOLA on save.

Using saved references

- **Copy OSCOLA** — copies the footnote format to clipboard
- **Copy Bib** — copies the bibliography entry format
- **→ Chat** — sends the reference to the Dialectic tab for discussion
- **Generate Bibliography** — outputs a fully categorised bibliography (Table of Cases → Legislation → Articles → Books) and copies it to clipboard
- **Table of Cases** — cases only, alphabetised
- **Table of Legislation** — legislation only, alphabetised

Why this matters: G.U.R.U. reads your saved references when answering Dialectic questions. If you have saved *Montgomery v Lanarkshire*, G.U.R.U. will cite it back to you in the correct OSCOLA format rather than generating a generic reference.

// 7. VIVA SIMULATOR

The Viva Simulator replicates a real PhD oral examination. G.U.R.U. takes the role of two examiners — an Internal and an External — and conducts a six-phase viva following QAA doctoral framework guidelines.

How to use it

- 1 Go to the **VIVA** tab
- 2 Enter a topic, chapter title, or research question in the Topic field (optional — leave blank for a general viva)
- 3 Click **Begin Viva**
- 4 G.U.R.U. opens with an examiner question
- 5 Type or speak your answer using the microphone button
- 6 Continue until the session concludes with examiner feedback

The six phases

1. **Opening** — thesis overview and positioning
2. **Theoretical framework** — foundations and literature
3. **Methodology** — approach and justification
4. **Original contribution** — the "so what?"
5. **Weaknesses and limitations** — hardest phase
6. **Conclusion** — reflections and future research

Best practice: Run the Viva at least once a week in the months approaching your actual viva. Use the Question Bank (Tools tab) to generate predicted questions from your vault and load them directly into the Viva for targeted practice.

// 8. PRESENTATION MODE

Drop any PDF presentation (conference slides, seminar slides, thesis diagrams) into the Present tab. G.U.R.U. renders it slide by slide and can discuss any slide in depth.

- Navigate with arrow keys or on-screen buttons
- Click 🎓 **Discuss with G.U.R.U.** to open the Dialectic tab pre-loaded with that slide as context
- Useful for preparing conference presentations and seminar papers
- Slides are rendered locally — nothing is uploaded to any server

// 9. TOOLS TAB

The Tools tab contains five specialist research utilities.

Document Paste Bridge

Paste text from Word, Google Docs, LibreOffice, or any source. Three actions are available:

- → **Analyse in Chat** — sends the text to the Dialectic with a doctoral critique prompt
- → **Add to Vault** — stores the text as a vault entry instantly
- → **Diff & Edit** — copies it to the Diff tool for revision

OSCOLA Citation Formatter

Paste any raw reference in any format (APA, Chicago, plain text, URL). G.U.R.U. returns the perfect OSCOLA 4th edition citation. Click **Insert at Cursor** to paste directly into a document (when using the Google Docs or Word add-on).

Argument Map

Generates a visual flowchart of your current chat session's argument structure — main claims, supporting evidence, counterarguments, and their relationships. Rendered using Mermaid.js. Click [↗](#) **Open in mermaid.live** if you want to edit the diagram further.

Document Diff

Paste an original paragraph and a revised version — G.U.R.U. highlights every word-level change in red (deleted) and green (added). Leave the Revised field blank and G.U.R.U. will suggest a revised version itself, then show the diff.

Viva Question Bank

Generates 12 predicted viva questions from your vault contents — covering theoretical foundations, methodology, original contribution, limitations, and policy implications. Click any question to load it directly into the Viva Simulator.

// 10. ARCHIVE

The Archive tab stores every conversation in reverse chronological order. Options available for each session:

- **Export to Vault** — saves the full conversation as a searchable vault entry

- **Download .md** — exports the session as a Markdown file Pro
- **Download .docx** — exports as a formatted Word document Pro
- **Clear Archive** — requires two-click confirmation to prevent accidental deletion

// 11. VOICE – G.U.R.U. SPEAKS

G.U.R.U. can read responses aloud using Gemini TTS — high-quality neural voices with academic gravitas. Toggle voice output using the  **Voice** button in the header.

Selecting a voice

Go to **CONFIG** → select a voice from the **G.U.R.U. Voice** dropdown:

VOICE	CHARACTER
Charon	Deep, authoritative gravitas — recommended for supervision
Fenrir	Powerful, commanding baritone
Kore	Precise, professional clarity
Aoede	Warm, measured engagement
Puck	Clear, articulate delivery
System Voice	Your device's built-in TTS — no API cost

Voice responses are processed sentence by sentence — G.U.R.U. begins speaking the first sentence while fetching the next, so there is minimal delay on long responses.

// 12. CLOUD SYNC **PRO**

Cloud Sync connects your vault and chat history to a private cloud node that you can access from any device. It is secured by a passphrase — G.U.R.U. derives a SHA-256 hash of your passphrase and uses that as your unique node identifier. No username, no account.

- 1 Go to **CONFIG** → scroll to **Cloud Sync**
- 2 Choose a memorable passphrase (treat it like a password — if you lose it, your cloud data is inaccessible)
- 3 Click **Save & Calibrate G.U.R.U.**
- 4 The sync dot in the G.U.R.U. name will pulse teal when sync is active

Important: Use the exact same passphrase on every device. The same passphrase connects to the same vault. A different passphrase creates a different vault node.

// 13. PLATFORM AVAILABILITY

G.U.R.U. is available across all major platforms. All share the same vault when the same Cloud Sync passphrase is used.

Web App

jarvisphd-8oecb.web.app — works in any modern browser on any device. Install as a PWA for an app-like experience on mobile.

Desktop (Electron)

Native desktop application for Windows, macOS, and Linux. Full microphone access and offline-ready shell. Run via npm start.

Google Docs & Sheets

Google Workspace add-on. Ask G.U.R.U., push selections to vault, format OSCOLA citations, and insert footnotes — all without leaving your document.

Microsoft Word

Office Add-in with full task pane sidebar. Sideload the manifest.xml from the word-addin folder. Works in Word Desktop and Word Online.

OnlyOffice

Plugin available via Plugin Manager. Install by URL: jarvisphd-8oecb.web.app/onlyoffice-plugin/config.json

LibreOffice

UNO macro extension (.oxt). Provides OSCOLA footnotes, author lookup, AI research assistant, bibliography builder, and vault sync directly in Writer.

// 14. G.U.R.U. PRO

Pro features are unlocked with a licence key in the format `JRVS-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX`. Enter it in **CONFIG** → **G.U.R.U. Pro** → click **Unlock Pro**.

FEATURE	FREE	PRO
Dialectic conversations	✓ Unlimited	✓ Unlimited
Vault entries	✓ Unlimited	✓ Unlimited
Reference Manager	✓	✓
Viva Simulator	✓	✓
Voice output	✓ System voice	✓ All Gemini voices

Streaming responses	—	Pro
PDF vault support	—	Pro
Extended context (up to 20 messages)	6 messages	Pro
Temperature control	—	Pro
Download chat as .md	—	Pro
Download chat as .docx	—	Pro
Cloud Sync	—	Pro

Set your Research Focus first

The Research Focus in Config is the most important setting. The more specific you are — thesis title, university, supervisor name, key cases you are working on — the more calibrated and relevant every response will be. Update it as your thesis develops.

Build your Vault progressively

Every time you read a case or article, paste the key passage into the Vault. Within weeks you will have a comprehensive knowledge base that G.U.R.U. draws on automatically. Think of it as training your supervisor on your exact research.

Save references as you encounter them

Add references to the Refs tab as you discover them, not when you need them. Use DOI lookup for journal articles — it takes five seconds and generates perfect OSCOLA automatically.

Use Critique mode before submission

Before submitting any chapter, switch to Critique mode and paste each section. G.U.R.U. will identify every weakness your supervisor or examiner is likely to raise.

Run the Viva weekly approaching submission

Use the Question Bank tool to generate questions from your vault, then load them into the Viva. The more you practise under examination conditions, the less the real viva will surprise you.

Use the Document Bridge for drafting

Write in Word or Google Docs, then paste paragraphs into the Tools → Document Bridge for critique. Use the Diff tool with G.U.R.U.'s suggested revision to review changes word by word before accepting them.

Keep Cloud Sync active

Your vault and references represent months of work. Cloud Sync ensures they are never lost to a browser cache clear or device failure. Use the same passphrase on your phone, laptop, and library computer to access everything everywhere.

Keyboard shortcut: Press **Enter** to submit a question. Press **Shift** + **Enter** for a new line within your message.
